

Clariant AG

Recommendation **SELL** ★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Price CHF 12.38 [as of market close Oct 27, 2023] 12-Mo. Target Price CHF 13.00 Report Currency CHF Investment Style Mid-Cap Value

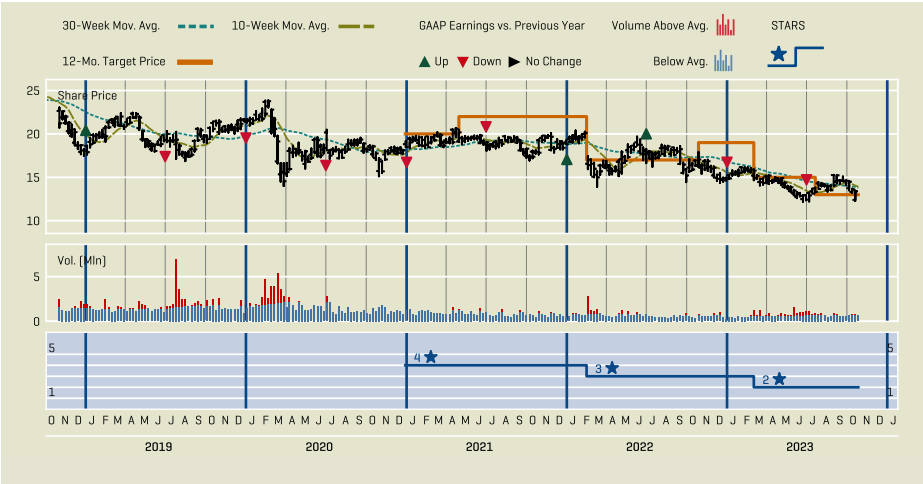
Equity Analyst **Adrian Ng, CFA**

GICS Sector Materials
Sub-Industry Specialty Chemicals

Summary Clariant is one of the world's leading specialty chemical companies with a diverse portfolio that are aligned with global megatrends.

Key Stock Statistics (Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence (SPGMI), Company Reports)							
52-Wk Range	CHF 17.92 - 12.07	Oper.EPS2023E	CHF 1.00	Market Capitalization[B]	CHF 4.07	Beta	1.10
Trailing 12-Month EPS	CHF -0.18	Oper.EPS2024E	CHF 1.10	Yield [%]	6.62	3-yr Proj. EPS CAGR[%]	3
Trailing 12-Month P/E	NM	P/E on Oper.EPS2023E	12.38	Dividend Rate/Share	CHF 0.82	SPGMI's Quality Ranking	B
CHF 10K Invested 5 Yrs Ago	7,738.0	Common Shares Outstg.[M]	329.00	Trailing 12-Month Dividend	CHF 0.42	Institutional Ownership [%]	20.0

Price Performance



Source: CFRA, S&P Global Market Intelligence
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied upon as such.
Analysis prepared by **Adrian Ng, CFA** on Jul 31, 2023 08:23 AM ET, when the stock traded at **CHF 13.65**.

Highlights

- ▶ Clariant's operations had remained relatively strong in 2022 with sales up 24% in local currency on strong pricing though 2023 is turning out worse. Q2 2023 sales decreased by 7% in local currency or down 17% in CHF as pricing remained flat Y/Y while volume decreased by 5%. The Care Chemicals business unit saw sales decline by 17% in local currency and the Catalysts business unit grew 30% in local currency while the Adsorbents & Additives business unit declined 12%. YTD 2023 sales decreased 3% in local currency or -11% in CHF.
- ▶ Q2 2023 EBITDA excluding exceptional items was CHF175 million, down 19% Y/Y in CHF attributable to the decline in volume. Adjusted EBITDA margin decreased 50bps to 16.1% with declines in all business units with the Catalysts business unit seeing a decline mostly on the negative impact of sunliquid. The Care Chemicals business unit saw a 530bps decline in EBITDA margin with volumes and pricing both declining, while the Adsorbents & Additives business unit saw a 1720bps decline with a significant decline in volumes and slightly positive pricing.
- ▶ Our EPS estimates for 2023 and 2024 are CHF1.00 and CHF1.10, respectively.

Investment Rationale/Risk

- ▶ Our recommendation is 2-STARS [Sell]. Clariant is one of the leading specialty chemical companies in the world with a portfolio that ties into global megatrends. In recent years, Clariant has adjusted its portfolio to higher growth and margin business areas as part of its greater corporate strategy. The Group intends to continue reshaping its portfolio to be a more focused, sustainable, and innovative specialty chemical company. Further, the focus performance programs and cost controls will help the company achieve better profitability and cash generation in the mid-term in our opinion. In 2023, the SIX Exchange Regulation [SER] has submitted a request for sanction to the Sanctions Commission of SIX Group against Clariant concerning alleged violations of financial reporting, relating to its own whistleblower probe in early 2022. We remain negative as we see this as a cloud over Clariant's head.
- ▶ Risks to our recommendation include a substantial increase in economic activity, a stronger oil & gas market, and favorable sale prices in its divestments for portfolio rightsizing.
- ▶ Our target price of CHF15 represents a 2023 P/E multiple of 13.6x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages.

Analyst's Risk Assessment

LOW MEDIUM HIGH

Our risk assessment takes into account Clariant's position as a leading specialty chemical company and its diverse portfolio.

Revenue/Earnings Data

Revenue (Million CHF)	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 5,150
2023	2,284	--	E 4,998
2022	2,563	2,635	5,198
2021	2,034	2,338	4,372
2020	1,945	1,915	3,860
2019	2,229	--	4,399

Earnings Per Share (CHF)

	1H	2H	Year
2024	--	--	E 1.10
2023	0.56	--	E 1.00
2022	0.59	-0.74	-0.15
2021	0.30	0.63	0.93
2020	0.31	0.34	0.65
2019	0.41	0.46	0.87

Fiscal Year ended Dec 31. EPS Estimates based on CFRA's Operating Earnings; historical earnings are adjusted. In periods where a different currency has been reported, this has been adjusted to match the current quoted currency.

Dividend Data

Amount (CHF)	Date Decl.	Ex-Div. Date	Stk. of Record	Payment Date
0.4200	Jun 01	Jun 02	Jun 05	Jun 06 '23
0.4000	Jun 02	Sep 08	Sep 09	Sep 12 '22
0.7000	Feb 15	Jun 30	Jul 01	Jul 02 '21
0.6150	Jun 08	Jul 06	Jul 07	Jul 08 '20
2.3850	Jun 10	Jul 06	Jul 07	Jul 08 '20
0.5500	Feb 14	Apr 04	Apr 05	Apr 08 '19

Dividends have been paid since 1996 . Source: Company reports
Past performance is not an indication of future performance and should not be relied as such.
Forecasts are not a reliable indicator of future performance.
Dividends paid in currencies other than the Trading currency have been accordingly converted for display purposes.

Clariant AG

Business Summary Jul 31, 2023

CORPORATE OVERVIEW: Clariant is one of the world’s leading specialty chemical companies, contributing to value creation with innovative and sustainable solutions for many industries. Clariant’s portfolio addresses key trends, including energy efficiency, renewable raw materials, emission-free mobility, and conserving finite resources.

BUSINESS SEGMENTS: Clariant reports in three business areas: Care Chemicals, Natural Resources, and Catalysis.

CARE CHEMICALS: Care Chemicals comprises the Business Unit Industrial & Consumer Specialties (ICS), including Consumer Care, Industrial Applications, Base Products, Food Ingredients, and Encapsulation Technologies. New Business Development encompasses Electronic Materials and Additive Manufacturing/3D Printing. These are low cyclical segments that follow a lifestyle-driven megatrend and strengthen Clariant’s position as a supplier of green and sustainable products. Clariant expects a 5%-7% annual growth rate for this business area with an EBITDA margin target of 19%-21%.

NATURAL RESOURCES: Natural Resources comprises the Business Units Oil & Mining Services, Functional Minerals, and also Additives (since July 2019). It is characterized by high growth and low cyclical, as well as a strong megatrend orientation. Main drivers are the rising demand for high value-added specialty chemicals used in the oil, mining, food, and packaging industries, and the increased consumption of oil, gas, and base metals driven by fast-growing economies. Additives provide highly customized products, technologies, and applications mainly for the plastic and polymer as well as the electronics industries. Clariant expects a 5%-7% annual growth rate for this business area with an EBITDA margin target of 18%-20%.

CATALYSIS: Catalysis is the smallest business area within Clariant in terms of sales, but is highly profitable with high growth rates. Catalysis comprises the Business Units Catalysts and the Business Line Biofuels & Derivatives. It develops, manufactures, and sells a wide range of catalyst products for the chemical and fuel industries, ensuring that finite raw materials and energy are used efficiently. In addition, Catalysis is at the forefront of new market developments such as commercialization and bio-ethanol licensing. Clariant expects a 6%-9% annual growth rate for this business area with an EBITDA margin target of 26%-30%.

CORPORATE STRATEGY: In its three core Business Areas, Clariant focuses on developing differentiated, customer-specific products, and offerings that have attractive growth prospects and above-average value potential. The alignment of Clariant’s five-pillar corporate strategy and its excellence program supports the achievement of these goals.

Clariant’s five pillars are: focus on innovation and R&D, add value with sustainability, reposition portfolio, intensify growth, and increase profitability. Each pillar contains “must-win battles” that focus on Clariant’s strategy implementation and are aligned with strategic investment activities, such as enhancing investments in China and North America.

FINANCIAL TRENDS: Clariant declined its revenues at a five-year CAGR of -4% in the five-year period ending 2022 and its EBITDA at a five-year CAGR of -1% due to the divestments the Group made in its Pigments, Masterbatches, and Healthcare Packaging businesses. The Group has also shifted its sales towards core growth markets in the Asia Pacific and North America in the past 15 years. The Group’s adjusted EBITDA margin has improved following its divestments, going from 14.7% in 2015 to 15.6% in 2022.

Corporate information

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Officers	
General Counsel & Head of Group Legal Services	Chief Executive Officer
J. Bischoff	C. Keijzer
Independent Non-Executive Chairman	Chief Financial Officer
G. Von Au	B. Collins

Chief Technology & Sustainability Officer and Head of New Business Development
R. Haldimann

Board Members	
A. M. Al Umar	N. Shastri
C. S. Dyckerhoff	P. Steiner
E. M. Saupper	R. C. Gualdoni
G. Merszei	S. Wamsler
G. Von Au	T. Mannhardt
K. Winterstein	

Domicile	Auditor
Switzerland	KPMG LLP - Klynveld Peat Marwick Goerdeler

Founded
1886

Employees
10,690

Stockholders
N/A

Clariant AG

Quantitative Evaluations						Expanded Ratio Analysis					
Fair Value Rank	NR	1	2	3	4	5	2022	2021	2020	2019	
LOWEST						HIGHEST	Price/Sales	0.93	1.44	1.61	1.62
Based on CFRA's proprietary quantitative model, stocks are ranked from most overvalued [1] to most undervalued [5].							Price/EBITDA	5.96	9.58	9.84	15.72
							Price/Pretax Income	807.63	15.98	26.97	100.54
							P/E Ratio	NM	20.50	28.95	24.83
							Avg. Diluted Shares Outstg. [M]	330.77	331.39	331.02	330.48
							Figures based on fiscal year-end price				
Fair Value Calculation	N/A										
Volatility	NA	LOW		AVERAGE		HIGH					
Technical Evaluation	NEUTRAL	Since September, 2023, the technical indicators for CLN SW have been NEUTRAL "									
Insider Activity	NA	UNFAVORABLE		NEUTRAL		FAVORABLE					
Key Growth Rates and Averages											
Past Growth Rate [%]								1 Year	3 Years	5 Years	
Net Income								NM	103.28	NM	
Sales								18.89	5.72	-4.01	
Ratio Analysis (Annual Avg.)											
Net Margin [%]								1.62	9.93	7.53	
% LT Debt to Capitalization								21.88	25.09	27.54	
Return on Equity [%]								-3.99	4.29	3.78	

Company Financials Fiscal year ending Dec 31											
Per Share Data (CHF)		2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013
Tangible Book Value		4.08	3.28	3.15	3.51	3.39	2.99	2.35	3.31	3.51	3.66
Free Cash Flow		0.88	0.01	0.22	0.67	0.83	0.46	0.96	0.32	0.03	-0.06
Earnings		-0.40	0.80	0.32	-0.19	0.59	0.84	0.78	0.67	0.54	0.98
Earnings (Normalized)		-0.15	0.93	0.65	0.87	1.50	1.47	1.12	1.01	1.12	1.36
Dividends		0.42	0.40	0.15	0.55	0.55	0.50	0.45	0.40	0.40	0.36
Payout Ratio [%]		157.00	66.86	NM	NM	48.96	53.43	50.99	56.33	75.66	NM
Prices: High		20.40	20.70	23.88	22.45	29.48	28.03	18.87	21.70	18.83	16.55
Prices: Low		13.90	16.93	14.00	16.86	17.49	17.63	15.26	13.50	14.55	11.98
P/E Ratio: High		NM	22.30	36.70	25.80	19.70	19.10	16.80	21.50	16.80	12.20
P/E Ratio: Low		NM	18.30	21.50	19.40	11.70	12.00	13.60	13.40	13.00	8.80
Income Statement Analysis (Million CHF)											
Revenue		5,198	4,372	3,860	4,399	4,404	6,377	5,847	5,807	6,116	6,076
Operating Income		591.00	444.00	364.00	182.00	342.00	552.00	515.00	516.00	510.00	496.00
Depreciation + Amortization		276.00	267.00	269.00	330.00	325.00	301.00	265.00	257.00	282.00	284.00
Interest Expense		48.00	54.00	62.00	117.00	86.00	76.00	90.00	86.00	160.00	139.00
Pretax Income		6.00	394.00	231.00	71.00	281.00	437.00	338.00	300.00	379.00	345.00
Effective Tax Rate		1,783	25.90	43.70	147.90	24.20	30.90	22.20	24.30	38.00	6.40
Net Income		84.00	344.00	784.00	10.00	337.00	277.00	253.00	229.00	152.00	NM
Net Income (Normalized)		326.10	250.40	182.20	47.60	205.40	358.10	268.80	248.80	214.40	254.20
Balance Sheet and Other Financial Data (Million CHF)											
Cash		718.00	427.00	1,004	942.00	925.00	810.00	1,367	989.00	928.00	991.00
Current Assets		2,669	3,039	3,292	4,019	3,340	3,312	3,539	3,062	3,356	3,661
Total Assets		6,188	7,038	6,932	7,979	7,981	8,229	8,365	7,461	7,915	8,174
Current Liabilities		1,862	2,470	2,022	2,697	2,278	2,404	2,725	2,051	2,215	2,552
Long Term Debt		870.00	958.00	1,424	1,485	1,694	1,727	1,908	1,859	1,761	1,830
Total Capital		3,977	4,493	4,438	4,966	5,210	5,233	5,411	4,747	4,924	5,199
Capital Expenditures		208.00	357.00	287.00	272.00	235.00	247.00	297.00	372.00	310.00	292.00
Cash from Operations		502.00	363.00	369.00	509.00	530.00	428.00	646.00	502.00	334.00	301.00
Current Ratio		1.43	1.23	1.63	1.49	1.47	1.38	1.30	1.49	1.52	1.43
% Long Term Debt of Capitalization		21.90	21.30	32.10	29.90	32.50	33.00	35.30	39.20	35.80	35.20
% Net Income of Revenue		1.60	7.90	20.30	0.20	7.70	4.30	4.30	3.90	2.50	-0.30
% Return on Assets		5.59	3.97	3.05	1.43	2.64	4.16	4.07	4.19	3.96	3.51
% Return on Equity		-4.00	11.80	5.10	-1.20	7.20	11.00	10.40	8.70	8.50	11.90

Source: S&P Global Market Intelligence. Data may be preliminary or restated; before results of discontinued operations/special items. Per share data adjusted for stock dividends; EPS diluted. E-Estimated. NA-Not Available. NM-Not Meaningful. NR-Not Ranked. UR-Under Review.

Clariant AG**Industry Outlook**

We have an underweight view on EMEA Materials as industries face the effects of high interest rates and slower macroeconomic development in 2023. This follows the period of high inflation in 2022, though the Materials companies themselves have been able to pass on high cost prices down the supply chain. Prices have eased in 2023 as we expected, but volumes are not recovering as quickly due to the weaker macroeconomic conditions. For the end of 2023, we see some increase in prices, though volumes will remain lower.

The S&P Europe 350 Materials Index has underperformed the market in 2023 up to August 2023, down 0.9% vs. an 8.2% increase in the broader S&P Europe 350 Index during the same period.

For the Metals & Mining sub-sector, the growing concern over global economic growth remains a key risk to earnings in the short-term in our view – Global Copper Users PMI and Global Steel Users PMI improved slightly in August vs. July. However, this was solely driven by Asia as the U.S. saw a renewed deterioration in operating conditions while Europe declined further. We note ArcelorMittal (one of the largest steel producers) also lowered its forecast for global ex-China apparent steel demand growth in July to reflect the weaknesses in the U.S. and Europe markets (weakness in long products demand due to weak construction activity).

For the Construction Materials sub-sector, we expect growth to continue to be supported by infrastructure spending in the U.S. and, to a lesser extent, in Europe. However, other segments of construction will continue to be weak, as evident by the Eurozone construction PMI not having been in expansionary territory since April 2022. The weaker macroeconomic conditions make further recovery more questionable, in our opinion.

For the Chemical sub-sector, we continue to see growth recovery, particularly for the companies that are exposed to industries that have undergone major destocking in 2022, as volume growth outweighs pricing declines.

Overall, we are underweight on the industry due to the weaker macroeconomic condition despite the breadth of its end markets.

/ Adrian Ng, CFA

Sub-Industry: Specialty Chemicals Peer Group*: Specialty Chemicals

Peer Group	Stock Symbol	Exchange	Currency	Recent Stock Price	Stk. Mkt. Cap. (M)	30-Day Price Chg. [%]	1-Year Price Chg. [%]	P/E Ratio	Fair Value Calc.	Yield [%]	Return on Equity [%]	LTD to Cap [%]
Clariant AG	CLN SW	SWX	CHF	12.38	4,087.0	-20.2	-26.9	NM	N/A	6.6	-2.2	20.1
Arkema S.A.	AKE FP	ENXTPA	EUR	84.78	6,328.0	-13.2	6.1	9.0	N/A	4.0	7.2	26.1
Borregaard ASA	BRG	OB	NOK	150.60	15,023.0	933.9	985.6	16.0	N/A	2.2	21.3	21.2
Croda International Plc	CRDA	LSE	GBP	42.78	5,935.0	-24.9	-46.6	31.0	N/A	2.5	8.3	19.8
Dottikon ES Holding AG	DESN	SWX	CHF	198.40	2,725.0	-13.4	-14.8	31.0	N/A	N/A	11.6	7.0
HEXPOL AB (publ)	HPOL B	OM	SEK	96.20	33,248.0	1009.6	874.4	N/A	N/A	3.7	18.3	6.1
Johnson Matthey Plc	JMAT LN	LSE	GBP	14.56	2,662.0	-26.0	-36.3	8.0	N/A	5.3	10.6	34.9
Robertet SA	RBT	ENXTPA	EUR	770.00	1,604.0	-9.0	-7.7	24.0	N/A	1.1	13.8	31.2
Umicore SA	UMI BB	ENXTBR	EUR	22.34	5,371.0	-2.1	-34.1	11.0	N/A	2.5	13.6	31.5
Victrex plc	VCT	LSE	GBP	13.63	1,186.0	-18.0	-30.6	17.0	N/A	4.4	14.9	5.7
Wacker Chemie AG	WCH	XTRA	EUR	112.40	5,585.0	-18.1	-3.8	11.0	N/A	10.7	N/A	N/A

*For Peer Groups with more than 10 companies or stocks, selection of issues is based on market capitalization.

NA-Not Available; NM-Not Meaningful.

Note: Peers are selected based on Global Industry Classification Standards and market capitalization. The peer group list includes companies with similar characteristics, but may not include all the companies within the same industry and/or that engage in the same line of business.

Clariant AG**Analyst Research Notes and other Company News****July 31, 2023**

01:27 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Sell Opinion on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 13.65**]: We maintain our Sell opinion on shares of Clariant with the same target price of CHF13. This represents a 2023 P/E multiple of 13x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. As reported in its preliminary update, Clariant's Q2 2023 sales decreased by 7% in local currency or down 17% in CHF as pricing remained flat Y/Y while volume decreased by 5%. YTD 2023 sales decreased 3% in local currency or -11% in CHF. Q2 2023 EBITDA excluding exceptional items was CHF175 million, down 19% Y/Y in CHF attributable to the decline in volume. Adjusted EBITDA margin decreased 50bps to 16.1% with declines in all business units, with the Catalysts business unit seeing a decline mostly on the negative impact of sunliquid. The Care Chemicals business unit saw a 530bps decline in EBITDA margin with volumes and pricing both declining, while the Adsorbents & Additives business unit saw a 1720bps drop with a significant decline in volumes and slightly positive pricing. Our EPS estimates remain unchanged. / Adrian Ng, CFA

July 21, 2023

12:25 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Sell Opinion on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 13.65**]: We maintain our Sell opinion on shares of Clariant with a lower target price of CHF13 [CHF15]. This represents a 2023 P/E multiple of 13x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. In a trading update before its half-year report, Clariant reported a preliminary Y/Y sales decline of ~17% and a Y/Y EBITDA decline of ~25-30%, a faster pace than the declines in Q1 2023 on "very weak demand" in Care Chemicals and Additives alongside the impact from divestments, acquisitions, and negative exchange effects. With a weaker-than-expected Q2 and no recovery expected in H2 2023, Clariant lowered its 2023 sales guidance to CHF4.55-CHF4.65 billion [vs. CHF5 billion previously] and its 2023 EBITDA margin guidance to around 14.3-15.1% [vs. slightly higher than the 15.6% in 2022 previously] translating to an EBITDA of CHF650-CHF700 million for 2023. We lower our EPS estimates to CHF1 [CHF1.10] for 2023 and CHF1.10 [CHF1.20] for 2024. / Adrian Ng, CFA

May 08, 2023

05:15 AM ET... CFRA Maintains Sell Opinion on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 14.34**]: We maintain our Sell opinion on shares of Clariant with the same target price of CHF15. This represents a 2023 P/E multiple of 13.6x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. Q1 2023 sales increased by 1% in local currency or down 5% in CHF, while Q1 2023 EBITDA excluding exceptional items was down 23% Y/Y in CHF attributable to lower volumes and business mix. Adjusted EBITDA margin decreased 360bps to 15.3% with declines in all business units, with the Catalysts business unit seeing a decline owing to a CHF13 million negative impact from the impairment of its sunliquid plant in Romania. The Care Chemicals business unit saw a 140bps decline in EBITDA margin, while the Adsorbents & Additives business unit saw a 750bps decline. We are still concerned on the SIX Exchange Regulation's probe on Clariant, which is in relation to Clariant's recognition of unjustified provisions in the 2020 IFRS financial statements, which prompted it to delay the release of its 2021 results in February 2022. / Adrian Ng, CFA

March 03, 2023

05:26 AM ET... CFRA Lowers Opinion on Shares of Clariant to Sell from Hold [CLN SW 15.20**]: We lower our recommendation for shares of Clariant to Sell from Hold with a lower target price of CHF15 [from CHF19]. This represents a 2023 P/E multiple of 13.6x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. Clariant's operations had remained relatively strong in 2022 with sales up 24% in local currency [Q4 2022: +12%] and 19% in Swiss francs [Q4 2022: +7%] to CHF5,198 million, with pricing contributing 17%-pts and volume contributing 7%-pts to the topline growth while 2022 EBITDA excluding exceptional items was CHF893 million up 18% Y/Y. Our EPS estimates for 2023 and 2024 are CHF1.10 [from CHF1.20] and CHF1.20, respectively. On March 3, 2023, the SIX Exchange Regulation [SER] submitted a request for sanction to the Sanctions Commission of SIX Group against Clariant concerning alleged violations of financial reporting allegations. We turn negative on the combination of a more challenging macroeconomic environment and the uncertainties of this new allegation. / Adrian Ng, CFA

October 28, 2022

05:15 AM ET... CFRA Retains Hold Recommendation on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 17.37***]: We retain our Hold opinion on shares of Clariant with a higher target price of CHF19

[CHF17]. This represents a 2023 P/E of 15.8x, which is around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. 9M 2022 sales were up 29% in local currency [Q3 2022: +27%] and 24% in Swiss francs [Q3 2022: +20%] to CHF3.875 billion, with pricing contributing 18%-pts and volume contributing 9%-pts to the topline growth. 9M 2022 EBITDA excluding exceptional items was CHF690 million up 30% Y/Y in CHF as EBITDA margin increased 90bps to 17.8% with profitability improvements in the Care Chemicals and Natural Resources business areas while the margin in Catalysis was negatively affected by raw material inflation, logistics and energy costs, and suspension of business with Russia. Despite facing a challenging macroeconomic situation, Clariant reaffirmed its longer-term 2025 goals. We remain neutral as we see broader economic challenges ahead. / Adrian Ng, CFA

July 29, 2022

09:18 AM ET... CFRA Retains Hold Recommendation on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 17.60***]:

We retain our Hold opinion on shares of Clariant with the same target price of CHF17. This represents a 2022 P/E of 15.5x, which is around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages. Q2 2022 sales from continuing operations grew 29% in local currencies on strong pricing and volume growth, offsetting inflation in raw material, energy, and logistic costs leading to H1 2022 sales growth of 29%. Q2 2022 EBITDA before exceptional items increased 25% [H1 2022: +29%], with an EBITDA margin of 16.1% [H1 2022: 17.5%] as pricing fully offset the cost inflation. Clariant expects strong growth in 2022, with revenue around CHF5.0 billion [2021: CHF4.372 billion] and an improving EBITDA margin as ever increasing costs in 2022 get passed on to customers. For the longer term, Clariant is maintaining its goals for 4-6% profitable CAGR, EBITDA margin between 19% and 21%, and a free cash flow conversion of around 40%. / Adrian Ng, CFA

June 23, 2022

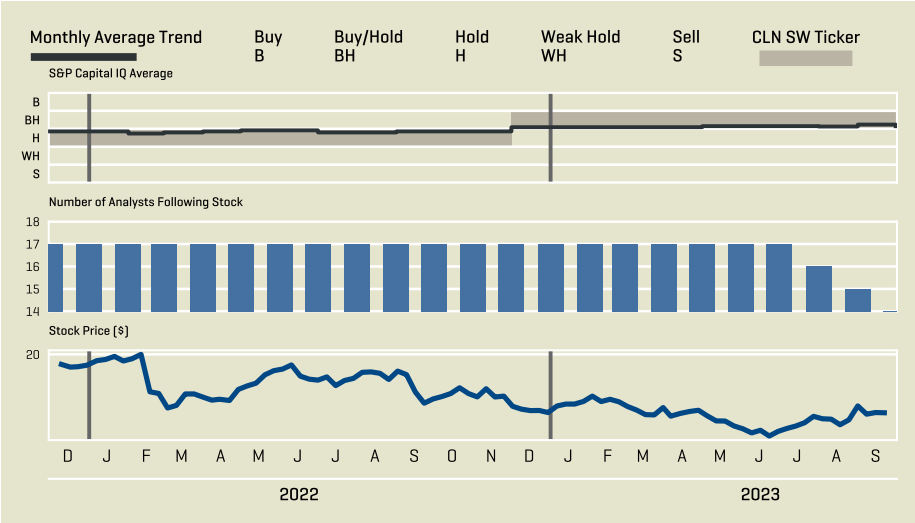
06:12 AM ET... CFRA Retains Hold Recommendation on Shares of Clariant [CLN SW 17.63***]:

We retain our Hold opinion on shares of Clariant with the same target price of CHF17. Clariant made an ad hoc announcement on its Q1 2022, announcing that Q1 2022 sales were up 30% in local currency and 26% in Swiss francs while EBITDA was up 27% to CHF220 million with an increased margin of 17.4% vs. 17.3%. The company also restructured itself to a simpler organization following its accounting probe, now operating in three business units, namely: Catalysts [combining Catalysts and Business Line Biofuels & Derivatives; Adsorbents & Additives [combining Functional Materials & Additives]; and Care Chemicals [combining Consumer Specialties and Oil and Mining Services]. The flatter organization structure is meant to improve business transparency. Our EPS estimates for 2022 and 2023 are CHF1.10 [raised from CHF0.90] and CHF1.20, respectively, implying a P/E of 15.5x, around 1 standard deviation below its historical averages justified by the current risk-off sentiment and execution risks of reorganization. / Adrian Ng, CFA

Note: Research notes reflect CFRA's published opinions and analysis on the stock at the time the note was published. The note reflects the views of the equity analyst as of the date and time indicated in the note, and may not reflect CFRA's current view on the company.

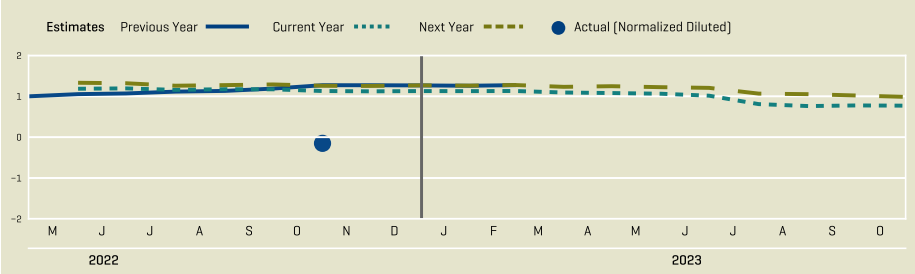
Clariant AG

Analysts Recommendations



	No. of Recommendations	% of Total	1 Mo.Prior	3 Mos.Prior
Buy	4	29	5	4
Buy/Hold	1	7	1	3
Hold	9	64	9	10
Weak hold	0	0	0	0
Sell	0	0	0	0
No Opinion	0	0	0	0
Total	14	100	15	17

Wall Street Consensus Estimates



Fiscal Year	Avg Est.	High Est.	Low Est.	# of Est.	Est. P/E
2024	0.99	1.15	0.79	13	12.48
2023	0.77	1.06	0.60	12	15.97
2024 vs. 2023	▲ 28%	▲ 9%	▲ 32%	▲ 8%	▼ -22%
Q3'24	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A
Q3'23	0.23	0.23	0.23	1	53.53
Q3'24 vs. Q3'23	N/A%	N/A%	N/A%	N/A%	N/A%

Forecasts are not reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: A company's earnings outlook plays a major part in any investment decision. S&P Global Market Intelligence organizes the earnings estimates of over 2,300 Wall Street analysts, and provides their consensus of earnings over the next two years, as well as how those earnings estimates have changed over time. Note that the information provided in relation to consensus estimates is not intended to predict actual results and should not be taken as a reliable indicator of future performance.

Note: For all tables, graphs and charts in this report that do not cite any reference or source, the source is S&P Global Market Intelligence.

Wall Street Consensus Opinion

Buy/Hold

Wall Street Consensus vs. Performance

For fiscal year 2023, analysts estimate that CLN SW will earn CHF 0.77. For fiscal year 2024, analysts estimate that CLN SW's earnings per share will grow by 27.89% to CHF 0.99.

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Glossary

STARS

Since January 1, 1987, CFRA Equity and Fund Research Services, and its predecessor S&P Capital IQ Equity Research has ranked a universe of U.S. common stocks, ADRs [American Depositary Receipts], and ADSs [American Depositary Shares] based on a given equity's potential for future performance. Similarly, we have ranked Asian and European equities since June 30, 2002. Under proprietary STARS [Stock Appreciation Ranking System], equity analysts rank equities according to their individual forecast of an equity's future total return potential versus the expected total return of a relevant benchmark [e.g., a regional index (MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, MSCI AC Europe Index or S&P 500® Index)], based on a 12-month time horizon. STARS was designed to help investors looking to put their investment decisions in perspective. Data used to assist in determining the STARS ranking may be the result of the analyst's own models as well as internal proprietary models resulting from dynamic data inputs.

S&P Global Market Intelligence's Quality Ranking

[also known as **S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings**] - Growth and S&P Capital IQ Earnings & Dividend Rankings stability of earnings and dividends are deemed key elements in establishing S&P Global Market Intelligence's earnings and dividend rankings for common stocks, which are designed to capsule the nature of this record in a single symbol. It should be noted, however, that the process also takes into consideration certain adjustments and modifications deemed desirable in establishing such rankings. The final score for each stock is measured against a scoring matrix determined by analysis of the scores of a large and representative sample of stocks. The range of scores in the array of this sample has been aligned with the following ladder of rankings:

A+ Highest	B Below Average
A High	B- Lower
A Above	C Lowest
B+ Average	D In Reorganization
NC Not Ranked	

EPS Estimates

CFRA's earnings per share (EPS) estimates reflect analyst projections of future EPS from continuing operations, and generally exclude various items that are viewed as special, non-recurring, or extraordinary. Also, EPS estimates reflect either forecasts of equity analysts; or, the consensus [average] EPS estimate, which are independently compiled by S&P Global Market Intelligence, a data provider to CFRA. Among the items typically excluded from EPS estimates are asset sale gains; impairment, restructuring or merger-related charges; legal and insurance settlements; in process research and development expenses; gains or losses on the extinguishment of debt; the cumulative effect of accounting changes; and earnings related to operations that have been classified by the company as discontinued. The inclusion of some items, such as stock option expense and recurring types of other charges, may vary, and depend on such factors as industry practice, analyst judgment, and the extent to which some types of data is disclosed by companies.

12-Month Target Price

The equity analyst's projection of the market price a given security will command 12 months hence, based on a combination of intrinsic, relative, and private market valuation metrics, including Fair Value.

Abbreviations Used in Equity Research Reports

- CAGR - Compound Annual Growth Rate
- CAPEX - Capital Expenditures
- CY - Calendar Year
- DCF - Discounted Cash Flow
- DDM - Dividend Discount Model
- EBIT - Earnings Before Interest and Taxes
- EBITDA - Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation & Amortization
- EPS - Earnings Per Share
- EV - Enterprise Value
- FCF - Free Cash Flow
- FFO - Funds From Operations
- FY - Fiscal Year
- P/E - Price/Earnings
- P/NAV - Price to Net Asset Value
- PEG Ratio - P/E-to-Growth Ratio
- PV - Present Value
- R&D - Research & Development
- ROCE - Return on Capital Employed
- ROE Return on Equity
- ROI - Return on Investment
- ROIC - Return on Invested Capital
- ROA - Return on Assets
- SG&A - Selling, General & Administrative Expenses
- SOTP - Sum-of-The-Parts
- WACC - Weighted Average Cost of Capital

Dividends on American Depositary Receipts (ADRs) and American Depositary Shares (ADSs) are net of taxes (paid in the country of origin).

Qualitative Risk Assessment

Reflects an equity analyst's view of a given company's operational risk, or the risk of a firm's ability to continue as an ongoing concern. The Qualitative Risk Assessment is a relative ranking to the U.S. STARS universe, and should be reflective of risk factors related to a company's operations, as opposed to risk and volatility measures associated with share prices. For an ETF this reflects on a capitalization-weighted basis, the average qualitative risk assessment assigned to holdings of the fund.

STARS Ranking system and definition:

★★★★★ 5-STARS (Strong Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark, by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares rising in price on an absolute basis.

★★★★★ 4-STARS (Buy):

Total return is expected to outperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 3-STARS (Hold):

Total return is expected to closely approximate the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 2-STARS (Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark over the coming 12 months.

★★★★★ 1-STAR (Strong Sell):

Total return is expected to underperform the total return of a relevant benchmark by a notable margin over the coming 12 months, with shares falling in price on an absolute basis.

Relevant benchmarks:

In North America, the relevant benchmark is the S&P 500 Index, in Europe and in Asia, the relevant benchmarks are the MSCI AC Europe Index and the MSCI AC Asia Pacific Index, respectively.



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Disclosures

Stocks are ranked in accordance with the following ranking methodologies:

STARS Stock Reports:

Qualitative STARS rankings are determined and assigned by equity analysts. For reports containing STARS rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of STARS rankings.

Quantitative Stock Reports:

Quantitative rankings are determined by ranking a universe of common stocks based on 5 measures or model categories: Valuation, Quality, Growth, Street Sentiment, and Price Momentum. In the U.S., a sixth sub-category for Financial Health will also be displayed. Percentile scores are used to compare each company to all other companies in the same universe for each model category. The five [six] model category scores are then weighted and rolled up into a single percentile ranking for that company. For reports containing quantitative rankings refer to the Glossary section of the report for detailed methodology and the definition of Quantitative rankings.

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STARS Stock Reports:

Global STARS Distribution as of September 30, 2023

Ranking	North America	Europe	Asia	Global
Buy	36.8%	34.5%	41.6%	37.4%
Hold	53.8%	51.2%	50.3%	52.6%
Sell	9.4%	14.3%	8.1%	10.1%
Total	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%	100.0%

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